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August 3, 1950

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Meeting with the President

Item 5. Formosa

I reported to the President the very difficult situation which was arising on Formosa as a result of General MacArthur's visit. I pointed out that our representative, Mr. Strong, and the Service attachés knew nothing of what had gone on. I pointed out that we had urged General MacArthur through the Defense Department not to go to Formosa himself at this time but to send a senior officer for the purpose of gathering information. We thought that he should go later after a political program had been worked out so that he could use his prestige for the results this Government wished. However, the discretion had been left to him and he had exercised it. Neither the State Department nor the Pentagon nor our people on the Island knew what had been said or done.

We had a report that three squadrons of jet fighters were to be stationed on the Island and some parties had already arrived. I asked the President whether he had authorized this which had not been included in any orders which I had heard. The President said that he had not and was opposed to it. I said that I would discuss the matter further with Mr. Harriman and Secretary Johnson tonight.

DECLASSIFIED
E. O. 11652, Sec. 3(E) and 5(D) or (E)
Dept. of State letter, ~~Aug. 6, 1973~~ 3-16-76
By NLT-[illegible] NARS Date 6-[illegible]-76

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